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QUOTATIONS

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THE MEMOIRS OF CARDINAL DE RETZ

By Cardinal de Retz





Louis XIII.



Anne of Austria



Cardinal Richelieu

*Always judged of actions by men, and
never men by their actions*

Always to sacrifice the little affairs

to the greater

*Arms which are not tempered by laws
quickly become anarchy*

Associating patience with activity

*Assurance often supplies the room of
good sense*

*Blindness that make authority to
consist only in force*

*Bounty, which, though very often
secret, had the louder echo*

*Buckingham had been in love with three
Queens*

*By the means of a hundred pistoles
down, and vast promises*

*Civil war as not powerful enough to
conclude a peace*

*Civil war is one of those complicated
diseases*

*Clergy always great examples of slavish
servitude*

*Confounded the most weighty with the
most trifling*

*Contempt—the most dangerous disease of
any State*

*Dangerous to refuse presents from one's
superiors*

*Distinguished between bad and worse,
good and better*

*Fading flowers, which are fragrant
to-day and offensive tomorrow*

False glory and false modesty

*Fool in adversity and a knave in
prosperity*

*Fools yield only when they cannot help
it*

*Good news should be employed in
providing against bad*

*He weighed everything, but fixed on
nothing*

*He knew how to put a good gloss upon
his failings*

*He had not a long view of what was
beyond his reach*

*Help to blind the rest of mankind, and
they even become blinder*

*His ideas were infinitely above his
capacity*

His wit was far inferior to his courage

*Impossible for her to live without
being in love with somebody*

Inconvenience of popularity

*Insinuation is of more service than
that of persuasion*

*Is there a greater in the world than
heading a party?*

*Kinds of fear only to be removed by
higher degrees of terror*

*Laws without the protection of arms
sink into contempt*

*Man that supposed everybody had a back
door*

*Maxims showed not great regard for
virtue*

*Mazarin: embezzling some nine millions
of the public money*

*Men of irresolution are apt to catch at
all overtures*

*More ambitious than was consistent with
morality*

*My utmost to save other souls, though I
took no care of my own*

*Need of caution in what we say to our
friends*

*Neither capable of governing nor being
governed*

*Never had woman more contempt for
scruples and ceremonies*

*Nothing is so subject to delusion as
piety*

*Oftener deceived by distrusting than by
being overcredulous*

*One piece of bad news seldom comes
singly*

*Only way to acquire them is to show
that we do not value them*

*Passed for the author of events of
which I was only the prophet*

Poverty so well became him

Power commonly keeps above ridicule

*Pretended to a great deal more wit than
came to his share*

*Queen was adored much more for her
troubles than for her merit*

*She had nothing but beauty, which cloy
when it comes alone*

*So indiscreet as to boast of his
successful amours*

Strongest may safely promise to the

weaker what he thinks fit

*The subdivision of parties is generally
the ruin of all*

The wisest fool he ever saw in his life

Those who carry more sail than ballast

*Thought he always stood in need of
apologies*

Transitory honour is mere smoke

Treated him as she did her petticoat

*Useful man in a faction because of his
wonderful complacency*

*Vanity to love to be esteemed the first
author of things*

*Verily believed he was really the man
which he affected to be*

*Virtue for a man to confess a fault
than not to commit one*

*We are far more moved at the hearing of
old stories*

*Weakening and changing the laws of the
land*

*Who imagine the head of a party to be
their master*

*Whose vivacity supplied the want of
judgment*

*Wisdom in affairs of moment is nothing
without courage*

With a design to do good, he did evil

Yet he gave more than he promised

*You must know that, with us Princes,
words go for nothing*

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